

N8N COMPLETE COURSE · ZERO TO AI AUTOMATION EXPERT

What is Automation & Why n8n?

Lesson 01 · Module 1 — Foundations

Beginner Friendly

100% Hands-on

Free Notes on GitHub

SolutionsWithShahzain

What You'll Learn Today



What automation really is

A plain-language definition with a real-life analogy



Workflows, triggers & actions

The 3 building blocks behind every automation



n8n vs Zapier vs Make

An honest comparison — and why we chose n8n



Your roadmap & career path

6 modules from zero to AI automation expert

What is Automation?

“Software doing your repetitive tasks — automatically, on a trigger, without you.”

- You define the steps once
- It runs every single time — 24/7
- You only step in for exceptions
- Your time goes to work that actually needs you



Analogy: A Foodpanda Order

- You tap Place Order → the TRIGGER
- Cooking, pickup, delivery updates → the STEPS
- Hot food at your door → the RESULT

*You don't call the restaurant, the rider, or the kitchen.
Every step runs itself. That's automation.*

Manual Work vs Automated Work



Manual

- Hours lost every single week
- Human errors creep in when tired
- Can't scale beyond your own hands
- Boring work drains your energy

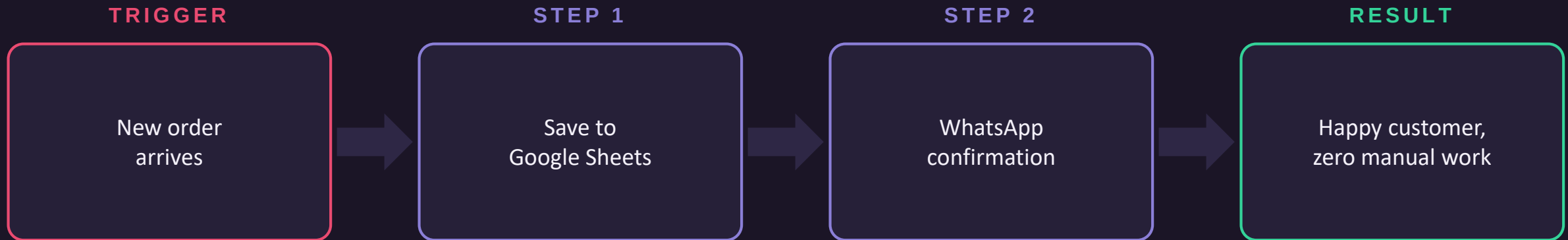


Automated with n8n

- Runs 24/7 — nights, weekends, Eid
- Same steps, zero mistakes, every time
- Handles 10 items or 10,000 the same
- You focus on growth, not grunt work

Businesses pay real money for exactly this difference.

Anatomy of a Workflow



Every automation = **one trigger + a series of actions.** That's it.

Meet n8n

Your automation Swiss Army knife

- Visual canvas — drag, drop, connect nodes
- 1,200+ app integrations out of the box
- AI-native — Agents, RAG & MCP built in
- Open source — self-host completely free
- Code when you need it (JavaScript & Python)

\$2.5B

company valuation (2026)

230K+

active users worldwide

150K+

GitHub stars

n8n vs Zapier vs Make

	n8n	Zapier	Make
Pricing	Free & unlimited (self-hosted)	Per task — costly at scale	Per credit (since 2025)
Self-hosting	Yes — full control	No	No
AI capabilities	Native AI Agents, RAG, MCP	Agents & MCP — usage-priced	AI Agents (beta) + MCP
Custom code	Full JavaScript & Python	Code steps, with limits	Metered — 2 credits/sec
Best for	AI + complex automations	Quick simple zaps	Visual mid-level flows

All three now have AI agents — the difference: n8n gives them to you unlimited, self-hosted, free. (Verified July 2026)

Why Learn n8n in 2026?

\$40–65/hr

average n8n freelance rate (US market)

800+

open n8n jobs on Upwork alone

174+

remote n8n jobs listed on Glassdoor

Every business has repetitive work. Very few people can automate it.
You're about to become one of them.

REAL PROJECTS FROM THIS COURSE

What You'll Be Able to Build



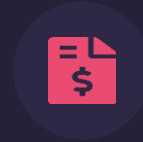
WhatsApp AI bots

Auto-reply, book orders, answer FAQs



Lead capture pipelines

Form → CRM → instant follow-up



Invoice & report automation

Documents that create themselves



Social media auto-posting

One post → every platform



AI customer support agents

RAG-powered, knows your business



Daily business dashboards

Numbers in your inbox every morning

Your 6-Module Journey

1

Module 1 — Foundations

Setup & your first workflow

2

Module 2 — Data Mastery

Expressions, logic & debugging

3

Module 3 — APIs & Webhooks

Connect anything to anything

4

Module 4 — Business Integrations

Real client-grade workflows

5

Module 5 — AI Agents, RAG & MCP

The 2026 superpower

6

Module 6 — Production & Freelancing

Docker, clients & income

42 lessons · 3 mini projects · 1 capstone: a complete AI business automation system

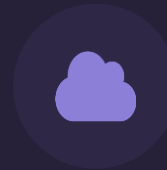
PREREQUISITES

What You'll Need (Spoiler: Not Much)



A laptop + a browser

4 GB RAM is plenty — n8n Cloud runs in the browser



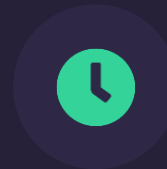
n8n Cloud free trial

We set it up together in Lesson 2



Zero coding background

Everything explained from absolute scratch



30 minutes a day

Consistency beats intensity — every time

Minimum config — Cloud: any PC, 4 GB RAM · Self-hosting (Module 6): 2 cores, 4 GB RAM, 20 GB SSD. (Verified July 2026)

Your First Assignment



Find 3 repetitive tasks — in your work, your studies, or any business around you.

1

What starts the task?

Identify the trigger — a message, an order, a date?

2

What are the exact steps?

Write them in order, like a recipe

3

How much time does it eat weekly?

That number = the value of automating it

Drop your best one in the comments — we might automate it live in this course.

Key Takeaways

1

Automation = a trigger + steps, running without you, 24/7

2

n8n: open-source, AI-native, free to self-host — built for 2026

3

Real career path: freelancing, automation services, AI agents

4

This course: 42 structured lessons, zero to AI automation expert

COMING UP NEXT

Lesson 02 — Setting Up n8n

Cloud vs Self-Hosted — which one for you?

- Create your free n8n Cloud account (together, step by step)
- First look at your automation dashboard
- Docker self-hosting — what it is & when we'll do it



Free notes + workflows
github.com/Shahzain-Ali/n8n-mastery



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